

Herman et al. 91 Teacher Stress, Burnout, and Coping Teaching is a high-stress profession, and many teachers experience serious emotional problems related to the stress of their job (Eaton, Anthony, Mandel, & Garrison, 1990; Montgomery & Rupp, 2005). Stress interferes with personal well-being and can weaken performance (Folkman, Lazarus, Gruen, & DeLongis, 1986). When teachers are stressed and not coping well, the relationships they have with students are likely to suffer, leading to negative academic and behavioral outcomes for students (Wentzel, 2010). Persistent stress can result in professional burnout. Burnout is the accumulation of responses to extended stressors caused by one's job; characteristics of burnout are emotional exhaustion, cynicism (depersonalization), and low levels of self-efficacy (Maslach, Schaufeli, & Leiter, 2001). Emotional exhaustion is a response to an over-whelming amount of demand from one's job (Maslach et al., 2001). Inefficacy comes from excessive demands and not enough resources to meet those demands; it is defined by self-perceived ineffectiveness (Maslach et al., 2001). The transactional model of stress proposes that stress and burnout occur when an individual has a negative appraisal between the demands placed upon them and their abilities to sufficiently cope with those demands (Sapolsky, 1998). Thus, teacher burnout, stress, coping, and self-efficacy are likely interrelated and multidirectional. Teacher burnout has been linked to teacher turnover intentions and job absenteeism (Belcastro & Gold, 1983) as well as irritability and diminished performance (Huberman, Grounauer, & Marti, 1993). A common conceptualization of burnout includes three components that are related to implementation of classroom practices, including emotional exhaustion, depersonalization, and sense of personal accomplishments from the job (Maslach, Jackson, & Leiter, 1996). In particular, emotional exhaustion, defined as the "tired and fatigued feelings that develop as emotional energies are drained" (Maslach et al., 1996, p. 28), is likely to interfere with a teacher's efforts to implement effective instructional practices and may influence the development of negative attitudes about and interactions with students (Lamude, Scudder, & Furno-Lamude, 1992). Not surprisingly, teacher burnout and stress have been shown to negatively influence teacher and student well-being (Beer & Beer, 1992; Geving, 2007). Specifically, Geving (2007) found that teacher behaviors elicited negative student behaviors, such as harming school property, criticizing other students, and talking back to the teacher. In addition, Kokkinos (2007) found that teacher burnout was significantly associated with higher levels of student antisocial and oppositional/defiant behaviors (e.g., cruelty/bullying, rudeness, deceiving or makes fun of schoolmates). Coping is a less considered aspect of teacher functioning, perhaps because it may be perceived as synonymous with stress. In fact, stress and coping are distinct constructs and each contributes important understanding to individual adaptation. Stress results from an imbalance between demands and resources that are available. Coping refers to the person's cognitive and behavioral efforts to manage (reduce, minimize, master, or tolerate) the internal and external demands of this person-environment transaction (Lazarus & Folkman, 1984). Therefore, it is possible for individuals to experience high levels of stress and still report adequate coping skills (Brenner & Bartell, 1984). This distinction may be especially relevant in today's high pressure school settings where most, if not all adults, may experience stressful environments but may have great variability in individual coping responses. Teacher Self-Efficacy Teacher self-efficacy is also negatively associated with teacher stress and burnout with available evidence suggesting reciprocal effects over time (Brouwers & Tomic, 1999). Similar to teacher burnout and stress, self-efficacy is associated with classroom management (Reinke et al., 2013). Conceptually, teachers who feel more confident in their capacity to manage classroom behaviors are more likely to deliver effective practices and observe positive student outcomes. In turn, positive student responses to effective classroom management serves as a positive feedback loop for increasing self-efficacy and the likelihood the teacher will deliver effective practices in the future (Han & Weiss, 2005). On the contrary, lack of confidence or efficacy may interfere with a teacher's ability to be effective in meeting the needs of students. For instance, Pas, Bradshaw, Hershfeltdt, and Leaf (2010) found that teachers with low efficacy were less likely to make referrals for their students to student support teams. Teacher efficacy is also related to student academic achievement. In a study on the academic gains made in a school year of primary school students, Muijs and Reynolds (2002) found that academic achievement and yearly gains were best predicted by teacher behavior. In addition, they found that teacher self-efficacy and subject knowledge affected teacher behavior, thereby creating an indirect relationship to student academic achievement. Self-efficacy predicts future behavior. Self-efficacy theory suggests that if a teacher experiences success on a task, then he/she is likely to believe that he/she will be successful again in that task (Tschannen-Moran & Hoy, 2007). Conversely, if a teacher perceives that he/she is not proficient in managing student behaviors or promoting the academic achievement of their students, then the teacher will be less likely to attempt to further affect these areas. Notably, self-efficacy is a malleable teacher characteristic that can be altered through cognitive restructuring and mastery experiences (Bandura, 1997). Thus, building self-efficacy and improved